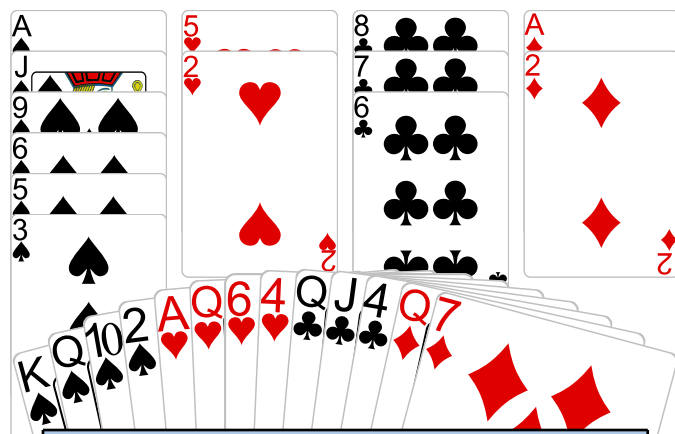
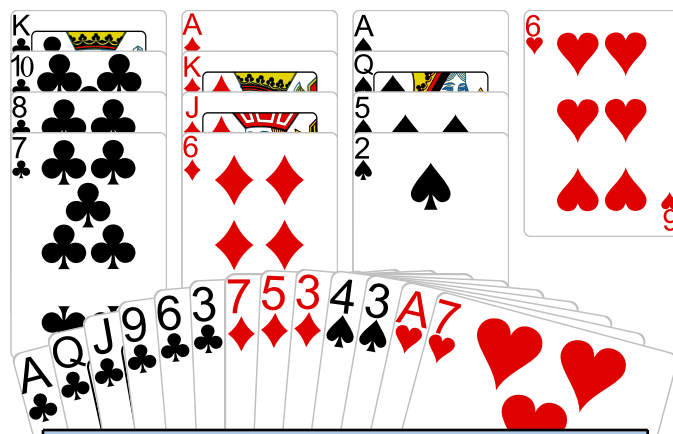


Deal 2 Ctr: 4 ♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 6 ♣ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6 ♣

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ J 10 8
♦ J 10 8 5 4
♣ A 9 3

♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North

If the defender who won the ♦K plays a ♦ or a ♣ you will ruff in your hand and discard dummy's ♥ loser. So that defender is going to have to lead a ♥.

If it is East who won the ♦K you are home free. His ♥ play will give you two ♥ tricks.

If it is West who won the ♦K you still have a chance. He will lead a ♥ and you will finesse the ♥Q.

In other words, played this way you make the contract whenever East holds the ♦K **OR** West holds the ♥K.

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With the cards as shown the elimination play works.

But if the ♦K is with West and the ♥K with East it wouldn't.

Of course it is POSSIBLE that if you played a low ♦ from dummy some Easts would duck and let you win a trick with your ♦Q.

This trickery would fail if East held the ♦K, or if West held it and went up right away.

South first transfers you to ♠s, then closes the auction with 4♠.

North is to play 4♠. East leads the ♣2. West takes the ♣A and returns the ♣9 to East's ♣K. East plays another ♣ to your ♣Q.

With two tricks lost already you have a sure ♦ loser (unless the defenders goof) and a ♥ loser that might be taken care of if West holds the ♥K. But what if East holds the ♥K? Maybe an elimination play.

First pull trumps - they split 2-1.

Next eliminate ♦s by playing ♦A then another ♦. This does the elimination and throw-in at the same time.

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 5 2

♥ 6

♦ A K J 6

♣ K 10 8 7

♠ K J 10 9 7 6

♥ K 10 3

♦ Q 8 2

♣ 4



♠ 4 3

♥ A 7

♦ 7 5 3

♣ A Q J 9 6 3

♠ 8

♥ Q J 9 8 5 4 2

♦ 10 9 4

♣ 5 2

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

3 ♣

Pass

4NT

Pass

5 ♥

Pass

6 ♣

All Pass

6 ♣ by East

will be into dummy's ♦ K J. If he plays a ♥ you will discard a ♦ from your hand and ruff in dummy. If he plays the ♠ K you will ruff, and dummy's ♠ Q will be promoted. If he plays a small ♠ you will let it ride to dummy's ♠ Q.

East plays 6 ♣. South leads the ♠ 8.

You have one ♠ loser and one ♦ loser. A successful finesse will take care of either one of them. Chance of the ♠ finesse working? Zero. Chance of the ♦ finesse working? Maybe 50%. Chance of an elimination play? Priceless.

Win the ♠ A and pull trumps with the ♣ A and ♣ Q. They split 2-1.

Play the ♦ A, just in case there is a singleton ♦ Q somewhere. There isn't. Then eliminate ♥s by playing ♥ A and ruff a ♥.

Now play a low ♠ from both hands. South doesn't follow suit as North wins with a small card.

North is end-played. He has no ♣s. If he plays a ♦ it

A fairly complex elimination play to finish off the set.

I hope you enjoyed them.